Brand and Memo Guide

How we present an Investment Committee Memorandum at Screen, First IC and Final IC. It applies to every memo built on the Merrow Vale PowerPoint template.

1 Colour

BRAND COLOURS

Plum	Antique gold	Warm grey	Ivory	Ink
#3B1F4A	#C8A24A	#6E6A66	#FAF7F2	#2A2328
Primary. Titles, table headers, cover band, KPI values.	Accent. Rules, bullets, section labels, second chart series. Never body text.	Secondary text: sources, footnotes, context lines, footer.	Cover background only. Never on content slides.	Body text on white.

SUPPORTING COLOURS

Plum tint	Mid plum	Lilac	Stone	RAG
#F4F0F6	#7A5A8C	#B9A3C6	#D8D2CA	
Tiles and table banding.	Forecast column headers; third chart colour.	Forecast bars and comparison series.	Rules, gridlines, table borders.	Green #4F8A5B, amber #E3A33B, red #B5483F. Diligence status and risk only.

Use only these colours. Gold covers no more than a tenth of any slide. Do not introduce other colours for emphasis: use bold instead. The PowerPoint theme carries the palette, so pick colours from the theme swatches rather than typing hex codes.

2 Typography

Element	Font	Size	Notes
Cover deal name	Georgia	54pt	Plum; one line
Action title	Georgia	24pt	Plum; a full sentence stating the conclusion, two lines at most, sentence case, no full stop
KPI and metric values	Georgia	40pt / 30pt	Plum
Body and commentary	Arial	12pt (11pt in dense layouts)	Ink; bullets are gold; one level of sub-bullets at most
Table text	Arial	10pt	Never below 9pt. If a table does not fit, cut rows or split it; do not shrink the font
Source, footnote, footer, slide number	Arial	8pt	Warm grey

Theme fonts are Georgia (headings) and Arial (body). Do not substitute other fonts, and do not type font names into text boxes: inherit from the theme.

3 Logo

◆ MERROW VALE

◆ MERROW VALE

- Files: `Merrow_Vale_logo.svg` and `.png` (plum wordmark, gold diamond) for white and ivory; `Merrow_Vale_logo_reversed` for plum.
- Clear space on every side equals the height of the capital letters. Minimum width 25 mm (1.0 in).
- Cover and divider: 3.0 in wide. Content slides: 1.9 in wide, top right, already in the slide master. Do not add a second logo.
- Never recolour, stretch, outline, add a shadow, or place the logo on a photograph.

4 Memo structure and rules

An Investment Committee Memorandum has three groups of slides. **Locked** slides are always present, always first and always in this order; their layout and fixed elements must not be changed. **Mandatory** slides must all appear after the locked slides; the deal team may put them in any order that suits the argument. The **appendix** is free.

#	Section	Layout	Rule	What it must contain
1	Cover	MV Cover	LOCKED	Deal name, descriptor, stage, date, deal team, and the footer “Strictly confidential”
2	Recommendation and ask	MV Recommendation and ask	LOCKED	One-sentence recommendation, cheque size, ownership, vote requested. Nothing else
3	Deal terms	MV Deal terms	LOCKED	Two-column term table (Term | Proposed) drawn from the term sheet
4	Investment thesis	MV Investment thesis – three pillars	MANDATORY	Exactly three pillars, each a claim with numeric evidence
5	Company snapshot	MV Company snapshot – KPI tiles	MANDATORY	Exactly six KPI tiles: value, label, context line
6	Market	MV Market	MANDATORY	Size, share, drivers, competition; one native chart
7	Financial performance	MV Financial performance – table + chart	MANDATORY	Six-year table (three actual years, three forecast) and a native column chart
8	Unit economics	MV Unit economics	MANDATORY	CAC payback, LTV:CAC, net revenue retention, logo churn; one native chart
9	Key risks and mitigants	MV Key risks and mitigants	MANDATORY	Three-column table: Risk | Mitigant | Residual (Low, Medium, High)
10	Valuation and returns	MV Valuation and returns	MANDATORY	Bear, base and bull with exit year, exit multiple, MOIC and IRR
11	Diligence status	MV Diligence status	MANDATORY	RAG table by workstream with adviser and headline finding
12+	Appendix	MV Appendix – free, divider	FREE	Any layout and any number of slides; custom slides are allowed here

Hurdle. The base case on Valuation and returns must show at least 2.0x MOIC and 20% IRR. If it does not, say so in the recommendation sentence. **Pillars and tiles.** Three pillars and six tiles are fixed; if there is more to say, move it to the appendix.

5 Stages and naming

Screen
First look. Slides 1–3 plus thesis, snapshot, market and key risks. Returns show the base case only.

→

First IC
All mandatory sections. Diligence status shows planned workstreams, with amber or red allowed.

→

Final IC
All sections complete. Diligence statuses are current to within three working days of the meeting.

- The cover shows the stage exactly as written above: **Screen**, **First IC** or **Final IC**. The memo itself is always called “Investment Committee Memorandum”.
- File name: `Company_Stage_IC_Memo_YYYY-MM.pptx`, with the stage as Screen, First_IC or Final_IC, for example `Fieldloom_Final_IC_Memo_2025-03.pptx`. Add `_v2`, `_v3` only for versions circulated after the Committee has seen one.
- Company name on the cover is the trading name, without “Ltd” or “Limited”. Deal team lines read “Name (Role)” with the lead partner first.

6 Number and text formats

Item	Rule	Example
Money	£m to one decimal. Below £1m use £k with no decimals. At £1,000m or more use £bn to one decimal	£22.9m · £38k · £1.4bn
Tables with a (£m) header	Number only, one decimal, no currency symbol	14.1
Negative numbers	Minus sign, not brackets	-£3.3m · -23%
Percentages	No decimals, except IRR, which has one decimal	52% · IRR 25.2%
Multiples	One decimal with a lower-case x. MOIC and valuation multiples alike	4.4x · MOIC 2.5x
Ownership	Whole percentage, stated as fully diluted post-money	11% fully diluted
Financial years	FY plus two digits plus A (actual) or F (forecast). State the year end in a footnote	FY24A · FY25F
Dates	Day, month in full, year in text. Month and two-digit year in tables and charts	18 March 2025 · Mar-25
Counts and periods	Thousands separator; “c.” for approximations; months and years written in full	31,000 · c.38,000 · 17 months
Currency	Reporting currency is GBP. Convert other currencies and state the rate in the Source line	€1.00 = £0.85

7 Sources, footnotes and footers

- **Source line.** Every slide that carries data has a line beginning “Source:” at the bottom left: Arial 8pt, warm grey. Name the document and its period; separate sources with semicolons. It lives in the *Source line* placeholder.
- **Footnotes.** Use a superscript letter ([a], [b], [c]) against the figure or label, and put the text above the Source line in the *Footnote* placeholder: “a. … b. …”. Do not use numbers for footnotes, and do not footnote the cover or recommendation slide.
- **Footer.** “Strictly confidential” centred at the foot of every slide; the slide number sits bottom right on every slide except the cover. Insert both from *Insert > Header and Footer*.

8 Charts and tables

- **Charts are native.** Build every chart in PowerPoint so the data stays editable. Do not paste pictures of charts or spreadsheets: paste spreadsheet extracts as tables where possible.
- Series order: plum, gold, warm grey, mid plum, lilac. Forecast periods use lilac or a lighter tint of the same series. No gridlines on column charts; data labels at 10pt.
- Table header is plum with white bold text; banding in plum tint; borders in stone. Numbers are right-aligned. Forecast column headers in mid plum.
- RAG cells show the letter G, A or R in the cell, never colour alone.

9 Working with the template

- Start from `Merrow_Vale_Memo_Template.pptx`. Add slides from *New Slide* so they pick up the named layouts (all prefixed “MV”). Use the “Blank” layout only for custom appendix exhibits.
- Do not rename or move the placeholders you use. Delete a placeholder you do not need (for example Footnote on a slide with no footnotes) rather than leaving it empty.
- Questions on the template or the guide: Investment Office, `investmentoffice@merrowvale.example`.